Sketch Explainer: install and customise

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This Skill turns one strategy, framework or idea from an article into a hand-drawn "pen on paper" explainer image: handwritten title, wobbly boxes and arrows, highlighter on the key words, doodle icons and one punchline. The kind of simple visual that gets saved and shared on LinkedIn.

Install it in the Claude app

1. **Turn on file creation.** Settings, then Capabilities, then *Create and edit files*. Skills need this on. On Team or Enterprise, an admin may need to allow it for your organisation. The Skill renders the image with code.
2. **Open Skills.** Click *Customize* in the sidebar, then the *Skills* tab.
3. **Upload the ZIP.** Click *+ Add*, choose *Upload skill* and pick `sketch-explainer.zip`. Don't unzip it first.
4. **Check it's on.** Open the Skill from your list. The toggle next to *Try in chat* should be on.

Or in Claude Code

Unzip it and move the `sketch-explainer` folder into `~/.claude/skills/` to have it everywhere, or `.claude/skills/` inside one project. It renders on your own machine, so it needs Python with Playwright; Claude installs them the first time if they're missing.

Make it yours

Open `SKILL.md` and fill in the *Make it yours* block near the top:

Setting	What it does
`signature`	A small handwritten line bottom right, such as "Jane Smith · acme.com". Leave it blank for no signature.
`pen`, `marker`	The pen and highlighter colours. Use a name (red, blue, yellow, green) or a hex code from your brand.
`audience`	Who the sketches are for. It decides which idea in the source is worth drawing.
`voice_notes`	Spelling and style, such as British spelling or lowercase titles.

Re-zip the folder (the folder, not the file inside it) and upload it again under Customize, then Skills.

Your first sketch

1. Start a new chat and paste an article, a report or your notes, or a public link.
2. Ask for "a hand-drawn sketch of the main idea". Say square for X or Substack Notes, portrait for LinkedIn.

3. It picks a layout to fit the idea (a list, this-vs-that, a 2×2, a flow, an equation or one big number) and renders a PNG.
4. Ask for changes in plain English: fewer words, a different layout, another highlighter colour.

Before you post, check every word on the image against your source. The Skill is told never to invent numbers or claims, but you are the one publishing it. Link the source article underneath the post.

If something goes wrong

Problem	Fix
Upload fails	Zip the folder, not SKILL.md on its own. The folder name has to match the `name:` line inside it.
No image comes back	Check *Create and edit files* is on under Settings, then Capabilities, and the Skill's toggle is on under Customize, then Skills. In Claude Code, let Claude install Playwright.
It looks cramped	Ask for fewer words. These work best at 25–60 words with a third of the page empty.

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